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GEC1044 Chinese Medicine Theory and Practice

Chinese Medicine : Theory and Practice (National University of Singapore)



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What Is Medicine?

- In the early 20th Century as China was going through a reform, intellectuals were questioning Chinese traditions as they felt they were holding China's growth. They wanted to do things the Western way.
    - Chen Yin Ke: "Effective medication but theories lack coherence".
    - Chinese intellectuals were abandoning Chinese medicine because it contains the 5 elements, the 6 qi, and were thought to be superstitious.
    - Assumption that science was purely a Western product, and could not be found in Chinese traditions.
- In the present day, we prefer Western clinics as we trust their medical interpretations of our illness — since it is backed by science.
- Modern medicine (Western medicine) is based on observing and seeing.
- In the past, fundamental theories of the human body cannot have arisen solely from observation of the body. It requires a model external to the body (life experience in actual or desired living environment). — MEDICINE IS CLOSELY RELATED TO CULTURE.
- Consciousness / qi is what is necessary for life, it is the immaterial aspect of our body.
- Emergence of medicine allowed one to recognise early processes in the body as "pathological". Physicians can predict how these processes develop to cause illness.
- Aim of medicine is to preserve life. To do so, it uses the scientific study of nature — nature of man and his habitat — applicable to people of all nationalities and religions.

Beginnings

- Many ancient cultures shared the common belief that causes of illnesses were related to the head.
- Trepanning — an operation to expel evil spirits from the head — was an early type of healing in the West, NOT used by the Chinese.
- The Chinese knew that the dampness from living in caves was causing them illnesses, so they tried to modify the environment (building houses). If they could not modify the environment successfully, they would relocate to other places.
- This developed a culture of hygiene, which was essential for the development of medicine.
- People began shifting from collective representation to their individual, as they started to realise that there was a gap between life and death, and that only their soul was immortal.
- During the Shang Dynasty, the Chinese believed that dead ancestors' displeasure were the cause of illness. The healers were the priests and the King. Most powerful cosmological force was 帝.
- During the Zhou Dynasty, the healers became the witches / shamans (巫). People switched to worshipping heaven (天). Power of the ancestors was now shared with other spirits who could make things difficult for the living. Trying

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to combat demonic adversity (鬼邪) led to the development of herbal medicine — using the herbs as poison, and acupuncture.

- During the Qin-Han Dynasty, the concept of spirits (神) was redefined. Blood and 气 combine to form the spirits of the body. 神 became closely related to the mind.
    - 脏 is tied to spirits, and they are long-term storage organs of the body.
    - 腑 are short-term storage organs of the body, not tied to spirits.
    - 神 is maintained if there is a healthy balance of 气 in the 脏.
    - Spirits are maintained through emotions (BALANCED, NOT EXTREME EMOTIONS): joy, anger, worry, grief, fear, fright and pensiveness (七情). Spirits are now under human control, not the other way around.
    - Organs can be repleted (實) or depleted (虛).

Natural Philosophy and Chinese Medicine

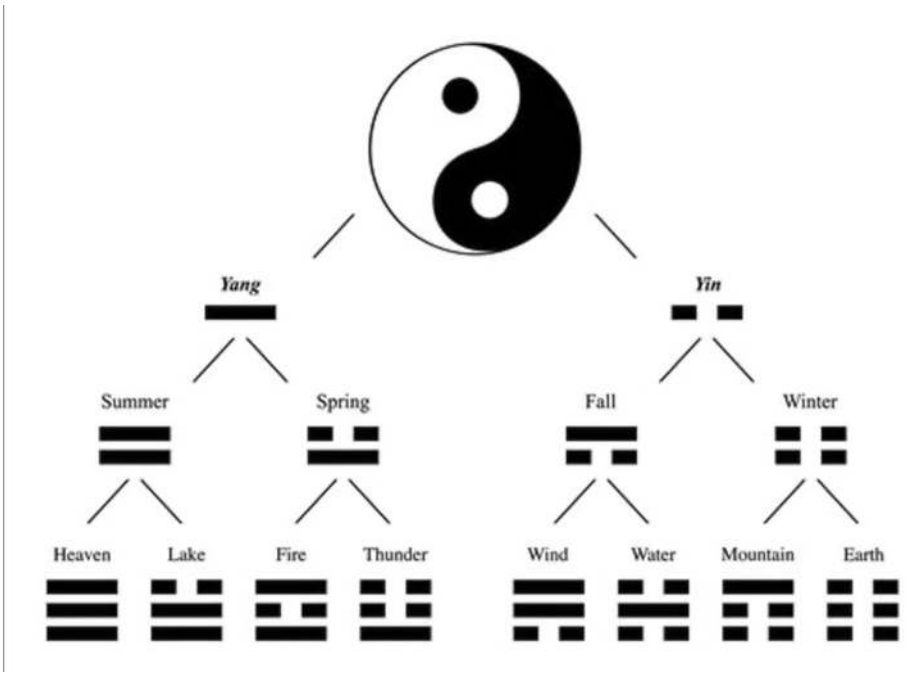
- Natural order was timeless. Thinkers started to view humans as intricately connected to nature. Humans should also follow the natural order and not try to change things.
- During the Warring States period, philosophy of the demons broke down, instead focussing on Yin-Yang, the five elements and Qi. This marked the beginning of natural philosophy in China.
- Integration of natural philosophy into Chinese medicine.

阴阳

- Yin-Yang: opposite, yet complementary forces.
- The natural philosophy can be used to explain forces of nature. E.g. the Yin-Yang concept was known for the creation of the world.

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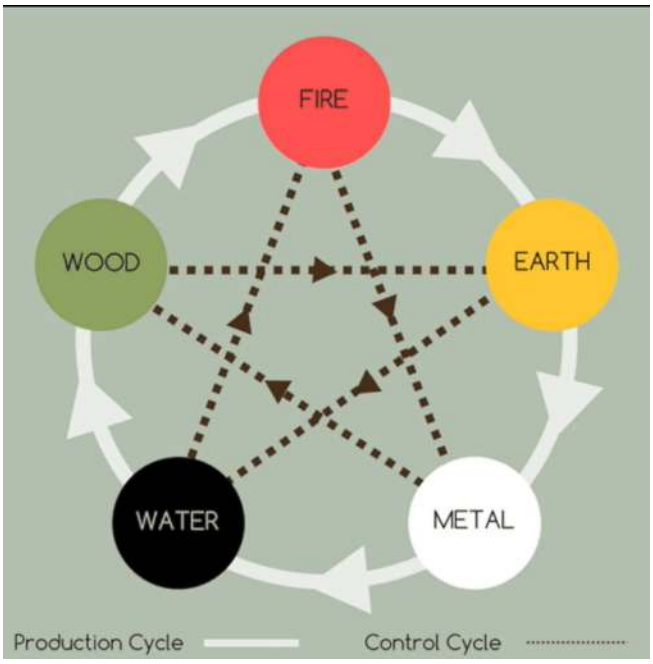
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- Systemic correspondence was exhibited as these shapes could be stacked together in many permutations, each having its own meaning.
- Yin: responsible for nourishing the organs, with fluids.
- Yang: responsible for warming the body.

The Theory of The Five Elements (五行)

- Originated from The Five Virtues 五德终始说, each representing an element — metal, wood, water, fire and earth.



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- The five phases are interconnected and associated with mutual generation and destruction.
    - Water: Potential of new life under water in **winter**.
    - Wood: Exuberance of new growth in **spring**.
    - Fire: Process of maturation under warmth of **summer** sun.
    - Earth: Ripening of grains in **late summer**.
    - Metal: Harvest of **autumn**, storage of seeds for next year's planting, beginning of new cycle.
- The generation / production of phases is one where each element generates the element after it — mutual generation.
- There are also checks in place to ensure the elements are balanced — mutual control / restraint.
- If there is imbalance, there will be destruction. The destructive cycle occurs when an element becomes too strong from its control element and uses up all its energy (气).
    - Earth absorbs water, water extinguishes fire, fire melts metal, metal cuts wood, wood breaks earth.

Organs & Meridians In Classical Medical Texts

- Authorship of 黄帝内经 is unknown. It is a compilation of several fragmentary texts of several authors.
- Date of completion is unknown. First book written no earlier than 4th century B.C. completed in 3rd century A.D.
- 黄帝内经 was finalised in paper book form and widely circulated by the Song Dynasty. It was divided into 2 parts: 素问 (Basic Questions or Inquiry into the Fundamental) and 灵枢 (discusses acupuncture in great detail).
    - Acupuncture needles are inserted in acupoints along meridian channels.
- Health and disease are influenced by natural ageing processes and the environment.

黄帝内经 View of the Human Body

- Viscerals (脏) and the bowels (腑) are found inside the human body.
- Body also consists of meridian organs (经络) — consists of meridian channels (经脉) and associated vessels or collaterals (络脉).

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The Affinities of the Five Agents to Yin-Yang Meridian Channels in "Basic Questions", Chapter 22, *Inner Classic of the Yellow Emperor*

Viscera	Five Phases/Agents	Season	Yin Meridian Channels (jing-mai 经脉)
Liver	Wood (mu 木)	Spring	Foot's jueyin liver meridian (zu jueyin gan jing 足厥陰肝经)
Heart	Weak Fire (jun huo 君火)	Summer	Hand's minor yin heart meridian (shou shaoyin xin jing 手少陰心经)
Pericardium (heart protector or xin bao 心包)	Strong Fire (xiang huo 相火)	Summer	Hand's absolute yin heart protector meridian (shou jueyin xin bao jing手厥陰心包經)
Spleen	Earth (tu 土)	Long Summer	Foot's major yin spleen meridian (zu taiyin pi jing 足太陰脾经)
Lung	Metal (Jin 金)	Autumn	Hand's major yin lung meridian (shou taiyin fei jing 手太陰肺经)
Kidney	Water (shui 水)	Winter	Foot's minor yin kidney meridian (zu shaoyin shen jing 足少陰肾经)

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The *yang* Six Bowels (liu fu 六腑) Organs and Corresponding Yang Meridians

Bowels (*fu*)	Five Phases/Agents	Yang Meridian Channels (jing-mai 经脉)
Large intestine (dachang 大肠)	Metal (jin 金)	Hand's supreme yang large intestine meridian (shou yangming dachang jing 手陽明大肠经)
Triple burner (sanjiao 三焦)	Strong Fire (xiang huo 相火)	Hand's minor yang Triple Burner meridian (shou shaoyang sanjiao jing 手少阳三焦经)
Small intestine (xiaochang 小肠)	Weak Fire (jun huo 君火)	Hand's major yang small intestine meridian (shou taiyang xiaochang jing 手太阳小肠经)
Stomach (wei 胃)	Earth (tu 土)	Foot's supreme yang stomach meridian (zu yangming wei jing 足阳明胃经)
Gallbladder (dan 胆)	Wood (mu 木)	Foot's minor yang gallbladder meridian (zu shaoyang dan jing 足少阳胆经)
Bladder (pangguang 膀胱)	Water (shui 水)	Foot's major yang urinary bladder meridian (zu taiyang pangguang jing足太阳膀胱经)

- Body also has essence (精), 气, and 神.
- 气 moves around the body in a regular rhythm through the 经络. 气 has to infuse movement through the blood so that blood can carry 气 through the body.
- Body is analogous to how the state was controlled.
    - The Emperor is the heart.
    - 器官 controls the movement of blood and 气 in the body.

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Correspondences between Imperial Bureaucratic Structures and Twelve Organs

Organs	Bureaucratic Title	Bureaucratic Function
Heart	Ruler (Emperor)	Spirit brilliance
Lung	Chancellor and mentor	Order and moderation
Liver	General	Planning and deliberation
Gallbladder	Rectifier	Decisions and judgement
Danzhong 膻中	Minister and envoy	Joy and happiness
Spleen and Stomach	Official for grain storage	Five favours
Large intestine	Official transmitter along the Way	Changes and transformations
Small intestine	Official recipient of what has been perfected	The transformation of things
Kidneys	Official operator with force	Technical skills and expertise
Triple burners	Official operator of channels	The path of water originates in them
Bladder	Official regional rectifier	Body liquids are stored in it

黄帝内经 and 阴阳

Yin-Yang of the Body in Chapter Four of the "Basic Questions" in *Inner Classic of the Yellow Emperor*

Yin 陰
Interior (li 裏)
The abdomen (fu 腹)
Five viscera (wuzang 五臟):
Heart (xin 心); liver (gan 肝); spleen (pi 脾); lung (fei 肺) and kidney (shen 腎)

Yang 陽
Exterior (biao 表)
The back (bei 背)
Six bowels (liufu 六腑):
Gallbladder (dan 膽); stomach (wei 胃); large intestine (dachang 大腸); small intestine (xiaochang 小腸); bladder (pangguang 膀胱) and triple burner (sanjiao 三焦)

- 三焦 can be considered as having a name but no form, as it is merely a collection of functions rather than a physical organ.

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黄帝内经 and 五行

Selected Correspondence between Five Agents and Phenomena in "Basic Questions", Chapter 5, *Inner Classic of the Yellow Emperor*

Five Agents	Direction	Quality	Flavour	Viscera	Body Part
Wood	East	Wind	Sourness	Liver	Sinews
Fire	South	Heat	Bitterness	Heart	Blood
Earth	Centre	Dampness	Sweetness	Spleen	Flesh
Metal	West	Dryness	Pungency	Lung	Skin and hair
Water	North	Coldness	Savoury	Kidney	Bone marrow

Chinese Medicine From Medieval to Late Imperial Period

From Han To Tang

- Medical texts from Mawangdui wrote that spirits were to be blamed as the perpetrators of diseases. There was no mention of Yin-Yang, or Five Phases, nor the natural laws that the body needs to follow — signifying that they all appeared from a great revolution.
- In the past there was a huge rift between drug therapy and acupuncture.
    - Drug therapy is the use of plant and animal-based medicine for treatment.
    - Drugs were associated with witchcraft, thus the elite didn't like it.
    - Many prescriptions were recorded in 伤寒论, which also combined ideas of systematic correspondence.
- Transformation of Daoism into a religion at the end of the Han dynasty.
- Pursuit of immortality led to the pursuit of using herbs in Chinese medicine — drug therapy became slowly accepted.
- Drug therapy became a major therapeutic method in Chinese medicine by the end of the Song dynasty.
- Buddhism came into China from India, and was redefined to fit local cultures. This also influenced Chinese medicine.
    - Important causes of diseases (三病).
    - Mediation techniques became important, resembling breathing exercises from the Mawangdui.
    - Government set up a ministry for research into medicine (in the Sui dynasty).
- Peace and stability of the early Tang dynasty encouraged innovation. Daoist influence was still dominant in Chinese medicine.

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Song-Jin-Yuan

- Song emperors were proficient in drug therapy and Chinese medicine.
- The elites in China transformed from “men of good birth” to “men of culture”.
    - In the past, state positions were given to the wealthy landowners, making one’s fate determined by one’s wealth instead of merit.
    - It changed to imperial examinations to find officials from both noble and base families — more meritocratic.
    - The Song emperors saw the education and examination system as reordering society and transforming the elite.
    - Development of Confucianism — influenced by Daoism and Buddhism.
- Medicine became popular among the scholars, worthy of their time and energy. They shaped how physicians studied and practised medicine, as they decided which medical texts were to be printed and circulated.
- Printing became cheaper, allowing for higher circulation of texts (identical ones). This led to the democratisation of medical knowledge.
- Government bureau is set up to correct errors in medical texts which are published. This included editing 伤寒论, a text that was widely forgotten but important for dealing with epidemics.
    - Circulation of books on drug therapy with more formulas and explanations for each illness, increased the prestige of drug therapy.
- By the end of the Song, the physician was no longer any healer, but a cultured scholar who had moral and social responsibility.
- Medical reforms of the Song dynasty. The government began to view healthcare as its responsibility (provided by charity institutions in the past).
    - Setting up of hospitals and pharmacies.
    - Subsidise medical drugs.
- New focus on the dynamics of qi transformation and how its breakdown led to 证.
    - Factors: Yin and Yang, external and internal, hot and cold, excess and deficiency.
    - Also influenced by the environment, body constitution of patients and the medical disorder.

Becoming ‘Traditional Chinese Medicine’

- Transmission of Chinese medical knowledge to Europe during the 16th Century.
- At the end of the imperial age, China began embracing Western medicine.
    - Western medical texts were also being translated to Manchu language and brought into China.
- Chinese medicine was revitalised post-1949, and transmitted to the West.
- Western scholars noted that Chinese medicine focussed on pulse instead of urine.
    - Read Chinese medical texts too literally, thus feeling that they were empirical medicine (not based on concrete scientific evidence).

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    - Difficulty in accepting Chinese medicine, but huge interests in them (many translations and interpretations of Chinese medicine).
- Chinese people came to favour Western medicine.
    - They were seen as more educated, and learned compared to Chinese physicians.
    - Western medicine provided clearer intervention and effect.
    - Western medicine concepts were also present in Chinese medicine, so were not unfamiliar to the educated Chinese.
    - Difference is the focus on morphology and anatomy.
- Pushing for abandoning of Chinese medicine.
    - Ineffective and not grounded in science.
    - Medical students schooled overseas returned to China to promote Western medicine.
- Transformation of China's medical scene with public health.
    - Development of masks, figuring out how infectious diseases are spread.
- Chinese medicine was transformed to integrate scientific basis. — Chinese medicine and Western medicine are not mutually exclusive.

Chinese Medicine in Singapore

- Chinese medicine in everyday life: drinking coconut water after vaccines, traditional chinese veterinary medicine, different chinese medicine being sold.
- Why are we using TCM? Effective to many people, avoiding side effects of biomedicine.
- In the past, locals were mainly reliant on TCM for treatment, but now, we have transitioned to using Western medicine.
    - In the past, TCM provided charity treatment for the poor, boosting the role of TCM in society in the past.
    - No licensing of TCM physicians — selecting physicians based on examinations, like in China.
    - The Chinese Medicine physicians brought the culture from China to Singapore.
- Localisation and adaptation of TCM in Singapore:
    - In the present, TCM cannot be integrated with biomedicine by law.
    - Halal-certified Chinese herbs. More Malays seeking TCM treatments.
    - More research into how ethnic differences can affect effectiveness of TCM treatment.
- Gaining credibility:
    - State support allowed TCM to gain credibility.
    - TCM is seen as a complementary medicine — primarily focuses on prevention.
    - Non-state actors (Singapore Chinese Physicians' Association, etc.) include research and charity halls. They reach out to all races.
- Common diseases in Singapore:
    - TB: Caused by external climatic factors (summer heat, dampness, fire) and internal emotions (七情) (anger, worry, anxiety, sadness, fear, fright), Pestilential Qi —> Qi deficiency —> phlegm.

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- Flu and common colds: Split into warm disease and cold damage.
- HFMD:
  - Symptoms: fever, lethargy, lack of appetite, blisters and sores, mouth ulcer, cough
  - Causes: Evil of the time (时邪), Epidemic Toxin (疫毒) enter via the mouth, nose and skin, Spleen deficiency, dampness and heat accumulated due to the fight with the toxin
  - Treatment: Resolve toxin (解毒), Clear heat (清热), Resolve dampness (化湿), Strengthen spleen (健脾)
- Eczema:
  - Symptoms: Itchiness, dry and rough skin, crusts from scratching
  - Causes: Improper diet, humid weather, living environment (Attap dwelling) → Dampness (湿邪), Wind (风邪), Spleen deficiency (脾失健运)
  - Food restriction: no spicy food, no fried food, no shellfish, no dairy.
  - Lifestyle: avoid using soap, no hot bath, enough sleep, no cigar or alcohol

- Singapore has more warm diseases due to the weather.
  - Environment plays an important role in causing different diseases in different regions (geographic locality).
  - Damp heat in the body due to our daily habits.
  - Formulae recorded in the classical texts were adapted to fit the needs of the local people.
    - Local plants are better than imported herbs in treating local people.
    - Prevention is better than cure.
- Cold diseases in Singapore: During monsoon season, poor eating habits, in the evening.

Comparison With Malay Medicine

- Similarities:
  - Focus on interconnectedness of organs in the body, and humans and the environment.
  - Concepts of energy, mind, and spirit.
  - Balance among different elements (water, earth, air, fire), deficiency and excess.
  - Hot / cold, damp / dry dichotomies.
  - Also use similar treatments: Herbs, food as medicine, acupressure, bone setting, cupping, incantations and rituals.
  - Particular time, frequency, direction, position, number to take medication.
  - Also related to the religious world view of the community.
- Differences:
  - Cupping: Wet cupping for TMM (suck out the toxins), but dry cupping for TCM (dispel cold and dampness).

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- Herb usage of Senna: relax bowels with purgative for TCM, used for different illnesses for TMM.
- Exchange of herbs between TCM and TMM.

TCM In Hong Kong

- In the 1850s herbal shops began setting up in Hong Kong, and by 1872, the first TCM hospital (TWH) was set up in Hong Kong to provide Chinese medicine treatment.
  - During the plague, TWH introduced Western medicine.
  - After that, people began to lose confidence in Chinese medicine. Western medicine became the mainstream of Medicine.
  - Chinese medicine services shrank even further during the Japanese Occupation. The Japanese government ordered the closure of free TCM clinics, and only offered free Western medicine clinics.
- Southward migration of Chinese scholars and practitioners to Hong Kong accelerated TCM development.
- After 1997, the government recognised Chinese medicine (exams for practitioners, university programs for Chinese medicine).
- During SARS, Chinese medicine practitioners collaborated with their mainland counterparts. — FIRST integration between Chinese and Western medicine.
  - CM was recognised to treat SARS.
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CM & Government

- Objectives of CM services in Hong Kong:
  - Model for CM training.
  - Systematise knowledge base of CM.
  - Promote development of “evidence-based” CM practice through clinical research.

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    - Develop standards in CM practice.
    - Develop models of interface between CM and WM.
    - Integrate CM into the public healthcare system.
- Government provides scholarships and fellowships for CM speciality training — currently CM in Hong Kong is very general.
- HACMK e-learning platform by hospital authorities to impart CM knowledge.
- Research ethics committee to evaluate CM research.

Integrative Medicine in Hong Kong

- Cross-referral between CM and WM based on the patient's choice.
- Develop evidence-based protocol to assess patient's suitability for the different types of medicine.
- Multi-disciplinary case discussions between Chinese and Western medical practitioners to decide management plans.
- Electronic health record to share medical data of the patient between Chinese and Western physicians.
- Herb-drug interaction database and guidelines.

The Art & Science of Traditional Chinese Medicine Diagnostics

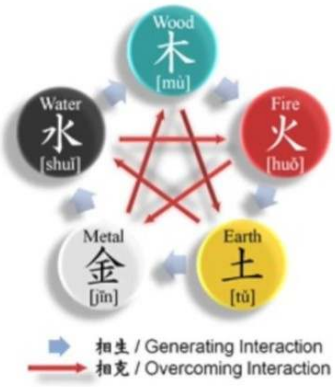
- TCM treatment process:
    - Identify the underlying patterns of disharmony, in a process called syndrome differentiation.
    - Diagnose the disease, matching disease and syndrome to customise individualised treatments to fit the patient's unique presentation.
    - MORE PATIENT-CENTRED, focus on OVERALL BALANCE.
    - Same illness can lead to different treatments based on different body constitutions.
- How does TCM diagnostics work?
    - Knowing the interior through the exterior.
    - Recognising the whole through observing a part — observing the tongue, feeling the pulse, diagnosing through acupoints.
    - Knowing the norm to identify change — consider Yin-Yang balance, spirit-body-mind balance, environment, societal factors.
- Restores the whole balance, not just targets the symptom.
- Principles of TCM diagnostics:
    - Holistic examination: Consider the disease causes, disease history, dynamic changes of Yin, Yang, Qi and blood, body constitution, family, environment, seasonal and climatic changes.
    - Synthesis of different diagnostics: Pay equal attention to all 4 diagnostic information and collect complete medical data.
    - Combination of disease and syndrome: Disease focuses on cause, mechanism, progression, and outcome. Syndrome studies the body's reaction in its current

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state. Combining both allows understanding the patient's situation and allows for formulating treatment.

4 diagnostic methods of TCM

- Inspection (Vision): Observe external conditions of the human body.
  - Visual inspection: Whole body.
    - Spirit: Expression, thoughts, consciousness, emotions, etc.
    - Colour: Five colours, skin lustre, facial features.



Green – Cold syndrome, Qi stagnation, blood stasis, pain, convulsion

Red – Heat syndrome

Yellow – Spleen deficiency, dampness syndrome

White – Deficiency (blood, Qi and/or Yang), cold syndrome, blood loss

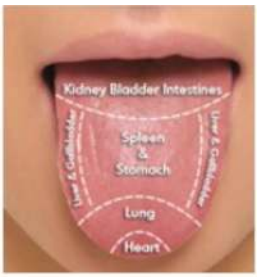
Black – Kidney deficiency, cold syndrome, retained fluid, blood stasis, severe pain

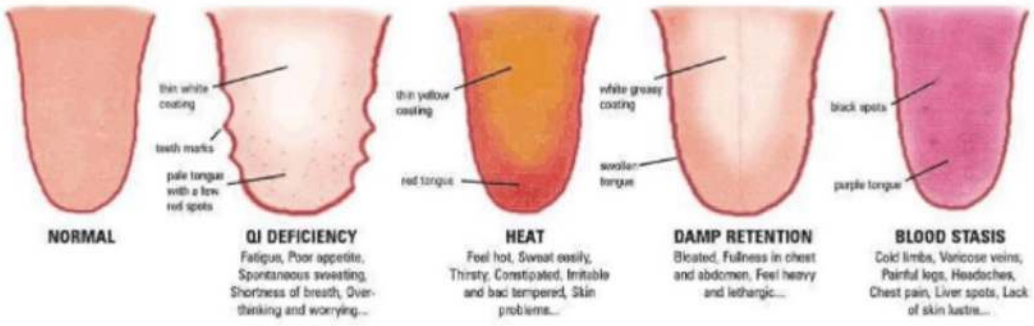
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    - Form: Strong / weak, fat / thin, body constitution.
    - Posture: Dynamic and static posture, abnormal movement / posture.
  - Topical inspection: Craniofacial, body, limbs, skin, etc.
  - Tongue diagnosis: Colour, shape, coating of tongue.
    -

Inspection (Tongue Diagnosis)

Tongue body – Indicates condition of Qi & blood of different organ systems (zang-fu)

Tongue coating – Indicates body fluids





  - Inspection of excretions: Phlegm, vomit, faeces, urine.

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    - Paediatric finger inspection: For children.
- Auscultation (Listen and Smell).
- Inquiry (Speech).
    - Detailed patient history.
    - Exploring symptoms, emotions and lifestyle.
- Palpation (Touch).
    - Pulse diagnosis.
    - Palpation (warm / cold, moist / dry, hard / soft, pain, abnormalities).
    - Depth of pulse:



3 Levels

Press fingers over radial artery first lightly, increasing pressure gradually to moderate force, then lastly to deep.

        - Superficial: External evils (Flus, fever, colds).
        - Deep: Weak constitution, or chronic disease affecting organs.
        - Rapid: Heat syndromes.
        - Moderate: Dampness, insufficient qi and blood to move between vessels.
        - Intermittent: Heart problems, terror, fear.
        - Excess: Strong pulse in all three positions — excess syndrome.
    - Width of pulse:
        - Thin: Qi and blood deficiency syndrome, or Yin deficiency syndrome.

Tension & Form

Xian Pulse, Wiry

- Long, feels like pressing on a violin string
- Indications: Stress, anger, Liver & Gallbladder disease, pain, Qi stagnation, or healthy elderly

Hua pulse, Slippery

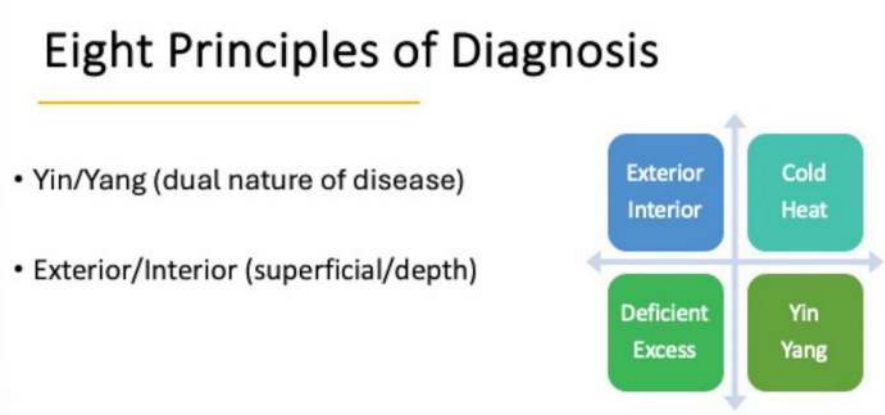
- Comes and goes smoothly like beads rolling on a plate
- Indications: Phlegm and fluid retention, food retention, excess heat, pregnant woman, healthy adults

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TCM Syndrome Diagnosis



Acupuncture & Cupping

Acupuncture

- Involves insertion of needles at acupoints (along the meridian system).
- Regulates elements (Yin, Yang, Qi, blood) and ensures smoother coordination between organs.
- 3 angles for acupuncture:
    - Flat needling: For areas with shallow skin (head / chest). Angle of entry = 15°.
    - Inclined needling: For areas with shallow muscles (neck / throat). Angle of entry = 45°.
    - Straight needling: For areas with thick muscles (limbs / lower back). Angle of entry = 90°.
- Reinforcing and Reduction Methods:
    -

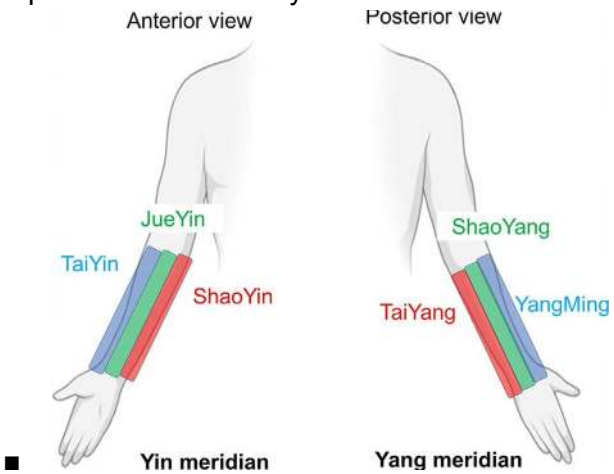
Types/ Forms	Reinforcing	Reduction
Twirling method	• twisting angle is **small** • force is **light** • frequency is **slow** • time is **short** • **thumb forward** while the **index finger is backward.**	• twisting angle is **large** • force is **heavy** • frequency is **fast** • time is **long** • **thumb backward** while **the index finger is forward.**

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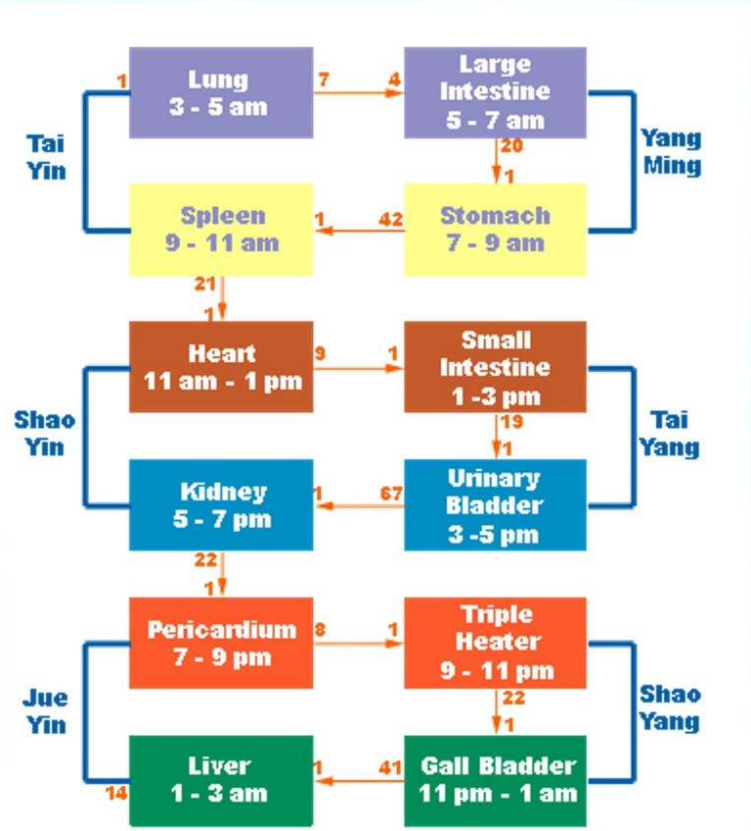
Types/ Forms	Reinforcing	Reduction
Lifting and thrusting method	• **deep and heavy** insertion • followed by **light** lifting • **small** amplitude • **slow frequency and short time**	• **shallow and light** insertion • followed by **heavy** lifting • **large** amplitude • **fast frequency and long time**

Meridian Systems

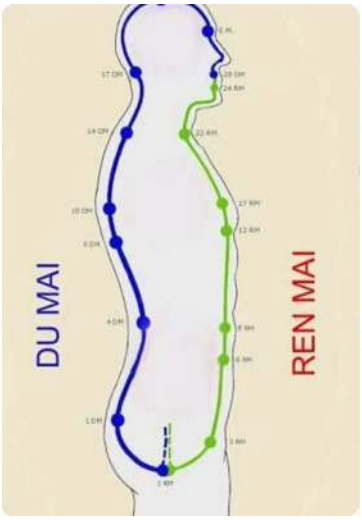
- Total of 14 meridians throughout the body — 12 principal meridians, 2 centreline meridians.
    - Principal meridians: Mainly start or end at the limb.



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- Centreline meridians: Ren, Du.

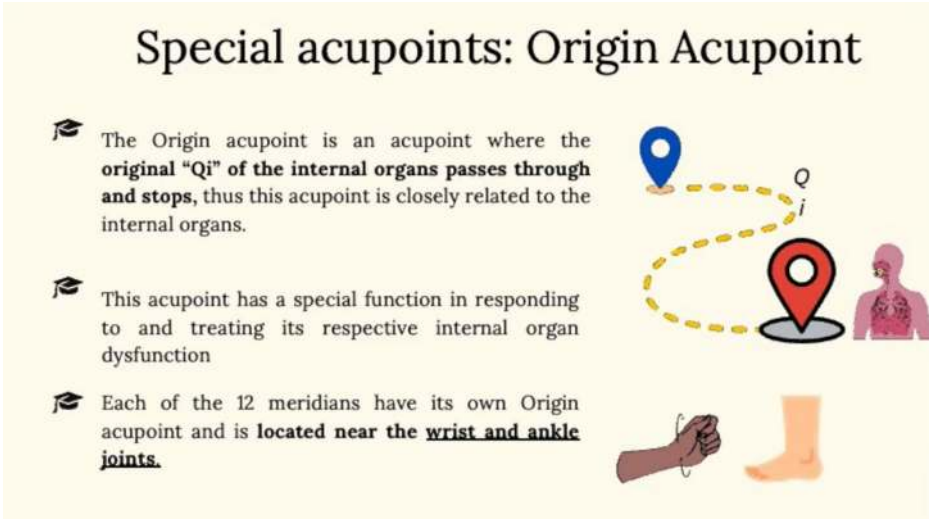


- Connect various parts of the body, allowing for coordinations.

Acupoints

- Special areas on the body where qi and blood are heavily concentrated.
- Stimulates acupoints to produce qi to fight the disease, by balancing Yin and Yang in the body.
- Determining location of acupoints:
  - Anatomical landmarks on the body.

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    - Proportional bone measurement.
    - Finger measurement method.
- Special acupoints:
    - Back Shu points: At the back.
    - 

    - Mu points.
    - Xi points: below elbows and knees.

Cupping

- Heated cups placed on the body to create a suction.
- Direct blood flow to the area of pain and do self-healing.
- Can clear blood clots within the body.
- Effects of cupping: muscle relaxation, promoting healing process, activation of lymphatic system, relieving musculoskeletal pain, improving digestive problems.
- Dry cupping and wet cupping.
- 

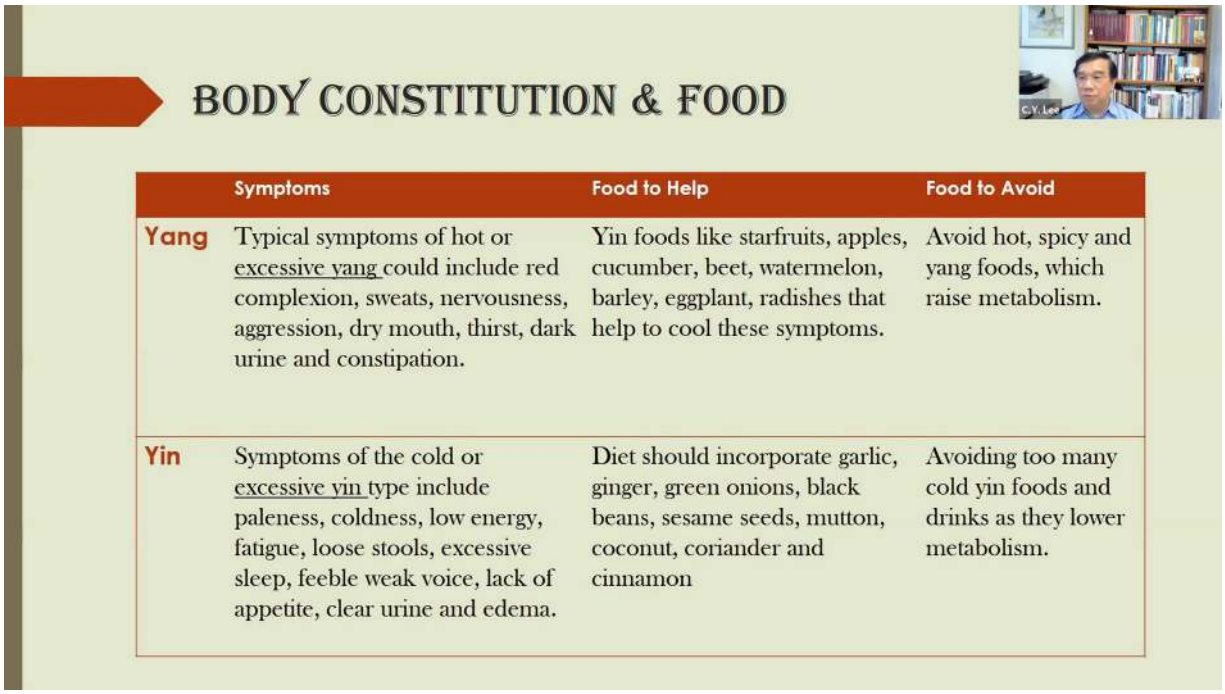
Food Therapy — Living in Harmony With Nature

- 2 basic understandings of food therapy in ancient Chinese Culture:

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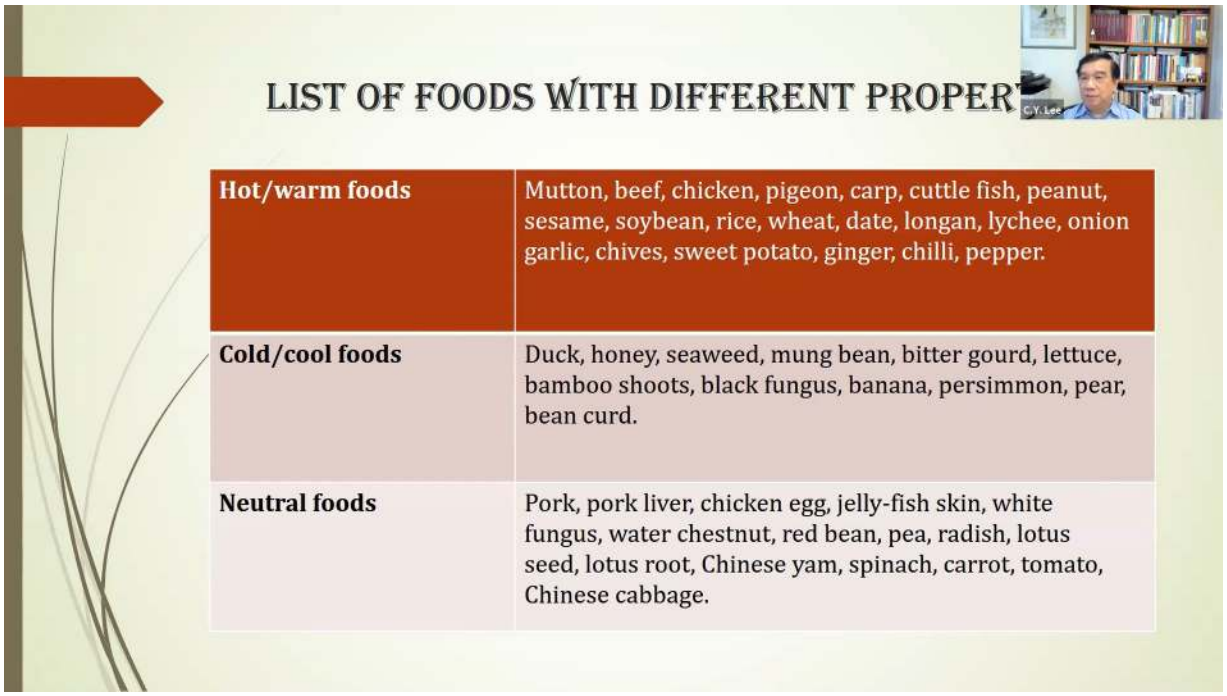
- Food and medicine are from the same origins — also shared by Western philosophy.
- Living in harmony with nature.

- Chinese food therapy:
  - Healing properties of food and correct the imbalances and disharmonies within the body, and promote health — FOOD IS VIEWED AS MEDICINE.
  - Food properties:
    - Nature (hot / cold / warm).
    - Taste (sweet, bitter, sour, salty, spicy)
    - Colour (white, black, green, red, yellow)
  -

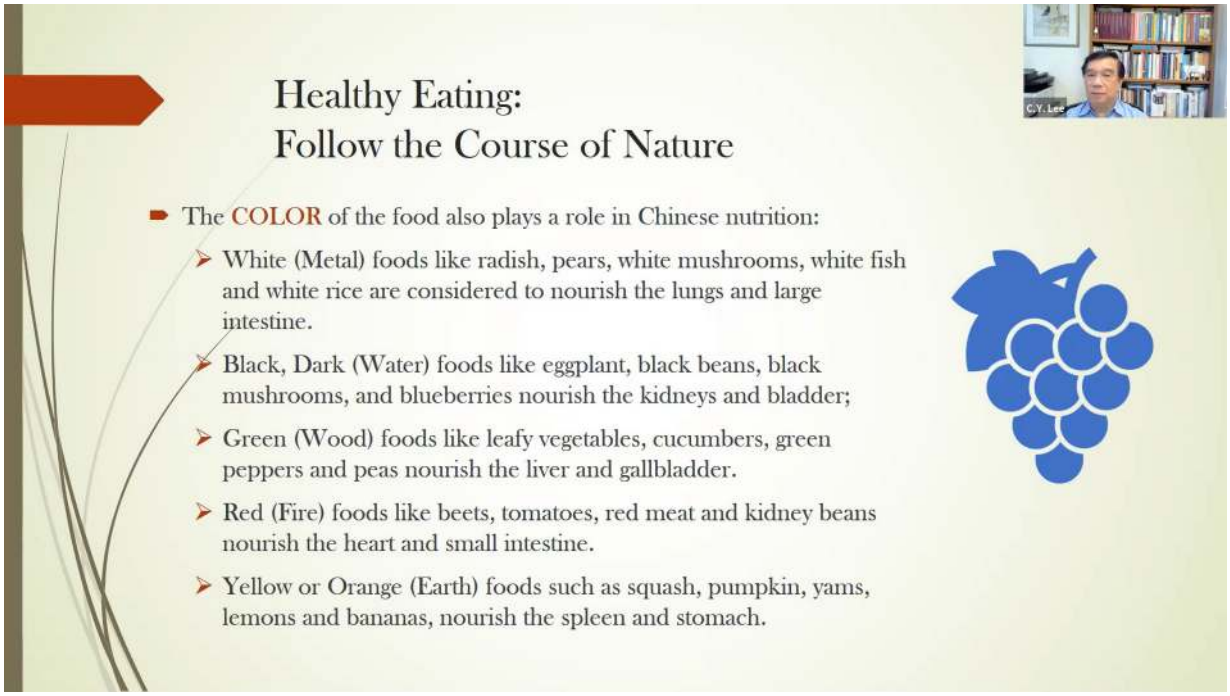


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- Healthy eating: Follow the course of nature.
    - Eat seasonally. Nature provides foods that correspond to the seasons that best support our bodies during particular times of the year.
    - In Spring and Summer, nourish Yang. In Autumn and Winter, nourish Yin.
- Adding herbs to enhance the nutritional and health value of food.
- 4 categories of herbs:
    - Imperial herbs: Key herb.
    - Ministerial herbs: To promote the action of the key herb.
    - Assistant herb: To decrease the side effect of herb.
    - Servant herb: To help the formulation.

Chinese Ideas of Health Preservation & Ageing

- TCM holds that humans are one with heaven and earth and the natural environment.
- Health preservation is concerned with maintaining health, preventing illness, and extending life span.
    - Cultivate body, mind, character, spirit.
    - Cultivate jing, qi and shen.
    - The mind is the starting point of preserving health.
    - 7 emotions are the activities of the mind: joy, anger, sorrow, fear, love, hate, desire. Ensure they are in balance and do not become excessive (prevents illness).
    - Emotions are linked to zang-fu organs. Ability to regulate these emotions are related to the state of Qi and blood in these organs, and body constitution.
- BOTH body and mind: body have to be active, mind have to be quiet — BALANCE.

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- Guiding and stretching exercise: 导引
    - Guides the qi and stretches the body.
    - Also a mental training of tranquillity.
- 3 levels of herbs:
    - Superior: for prevention.
    - Middle: for intervention.
    - Inferior: for treatment.

East & West — Integration of 2 Systems

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